

CareerMap

Your personalised career report

The Connector and Builder

Class 11 · Decision Window

PROFILE TYPE	TOP DOMAINS	GRADE STAGE
Decision Window	Building products people use every day Understanding how the mind shapes decisions Writing stories that change how people think	Class 11

3 careers · Personalised · 2025

ABOUT THIS REPORT

What is inside

You are in Class 11 or 12. Stream choices, subject selections and your first internship all happen in the next 12 to 18 months. This report is designed to help you make those choices deliberately, not by default.

Free counsellor call included

After you read this report a counsellor will call you within 48 hours. The call is to help you understand what is in here and decide on your next steps. It is not a sales call.

■ Your thinking style

How you process information and where you do your best work

■ Your strengths and blind spots

Drawn directly from your answers, not a generic template

■ Three career deep-dives

Each career covered fully: fit, paths, stream guidance, degrees, internships and your first 30 days

■ Parent summary

So they understand your direction without you having to explain everything

SECTION 1 — YOUR THINKING STYLE

How You Think

You process information by looking for patterns across different areas at once. You tend to hold multiple ideas in tension before committing — which means you rarely jump to the first answer, but you also sometimes take longer to start than others around you.

In practice, this shows up as someone who is great at synthesising — you can connect a psychology reading to a product decision in a way that most people miss. The flip side is that when there is no clear pattern yet, you can feel stuck. Starting with a small, concrete action usually breaks that.

SECTION 2 — STRENGTHS AND BLIND SPOTS

What your answers showed

Your strengths

■ Connecting unlike ideas

You draw threads between subjects that most people keep separate. This is exactly what product and strategy roles reward.

■ Staying with hard problems

Your answers show a consistent pattern of not giving up when something is unclear. You described sitting with a broken project for three hours before it clicked.

■ Reading people accurately

Across three separate answers, you described noticing what others are feeling before they say it. This is a rare and practical skill.

■ Explaining things clearly

You naturally reach for examples when you explain something. That instinct is what separates good analysts and writers from great ones.

■ Working across ambiguity

You listed economics, computer science and psychology as interests. Rather than a lack of focus, that range is a genuine strength in roles that sit between disciplines.

Areas to watch

■ Starting before the plan is complete

You described planning everything before starting. Worth noticing when a plan becomes a way of delaying the harder step of actually beginning.

■ Overcomplicating simple decisions

The same pattern-seeking that helps you synthesise can sometimes make a straightforward choice feel more complicated than it needs to be.

■ Saying yes to too many things

Your motivations include both making lasting things and understanding people. Both are real. But trying to pursue both at once, especially in Class 11 and 12, can spread attention thin.

CAREER 1 OF 3 — BUILDING PRODUCTS PEOPLE USE EVERY DAY

Building products people use every day

Why this fits you

You said you lose track of time when building tools, and you listed making things that last as your strongest motivation. Product work is essentially the discipline of turning that instinct into a repeatable process — figuring out what people need, building something that addresses it, and refining it based on how they actually use it. Your interest in psychology gives you an edge here that most technical people do not have.

Paths within this domain

› Product manager

Works with engineers and designers to decide what gets built next and why, balancing user needs with business constraints.

› UX designer

Designs how people interact with digital products, from the layout of a screen to the logic of a user flow.

› Growth analyst

Studies user behaviour data to identify what drives adoption, retention and revenue, then runs experiments to improve those numbers.

› Product marketer

Translates what a product does into language and positioning that makes the right people want to try it.

› Startup founder

Builds a business from scratch, which in the early stage means doing product, sales, hiring and strategy simultaneously.

Stream and subject guidance

Science with Maths is the most direct path — it keeps every technology and engineering degree open. Commerce with Maths is also a strong route if you lean toward the business and strategy side of product. Either way, Maths is important. If your school offers Applied Maths, confirm with your board whether it satisfies the same prerequisites as standard Maths before choosing it.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Computer Science (B.Tech or B.Sc)

Gives you the technical foundation to work alongside engineers and build things yourself.

› Economics

Builds the analytical and market-thinking skills that underpin most product and strategy decisions.

› Design (B.Des)

A direct entry into UX and product design, especially at firms where design drives the product.

› Business Administration (BBA)

A broad base for the commercial side of product, particularly useful in early-stage startups.

› Psychology (B.A. or B.Sc)

Increasingly valued in UX research and behavioural product roles.

Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Your counsellor will personalise this for your specific board, location and current subjects on the call.

Internships to target in the next 12 months

Early-stage startup (product or operations intern)

Search Internshala and AngelList India for product intern roles. Filter for startups under 50 people — you will get more real work and direct access to founders.

Design or product agency

Agencies like Obvious, Uncommon and Elephant Design occasionally take interns. Email directly with a short portfolio of any projects you have built, even personal ones.

Product teardown club

Start or join a group that reviews and critiques apps weekly. Post the teardowns publicly on LinkedIn or a blog — this builds a visible track record.

Hackathon participant

Devfolio and Unstop list student hackathons across India. A winning or placed entry at a hackathon carries real weight with product teams at tech companies.

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Download an app you use every day and spend 20 minutes writing down three things that frustrate you about it and one thing you would change. Post a short write-up on your notes app or a blog. Then read "Inspired" by Marty Cagan — the first three chapters are available free online and describe what product managers actually do.

- Have questions about this career section?

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CAREER 2 OF 3 — UNDERSTANDING HOW THE MIND SHAPES DECISIONS

Understanding how the mind shapes decisions

Why this fits you

You listed curiosity as the quality you most admire in role models, and you said you want to understand how people think and why they do what they do. That is not a casual interest — it came up in three separate parts of your assessment. Psychology and behavioural work gives you a structured way to pursue that, and the range of applications is wider than most people expect.

Paths within this domain

› Research psychologist

Designs and runs studies to understand how people think, feel and behave, publishing findings or applying them in applied settings.

› Behavioural consultant

Helps organisations change how their customers or employees make decisions by applying principles from psychology and economics.

› UX researcher

Talks to users, runs usability tests and synthesises insights to help product teams build things people actually want.

› Clinical counsellor

Works one-on-one with individuals to help them understand and manage mental health challenges, building a sustained relationship over time.

› Policy analyst

Studies how people respond to rules and incentives, advising governments or organisations on how to design better policies.

Stream and subject guidance

Humanities with Psychology as an elective is the most direct path, though it is not the only one. Science students can still pursue a Psychology degree at most universities. If your school offers Psychology as a subject, taking it now gives you a head start. Economics alongside Psychology is a strong combination for behavioural work specifically.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Psychology (B.A. or B.Sc)

The core degree for most clinical, research and academic routes in this field.

› Economics (with behavioural focus)

Opens the consulting and policy track, especially at institutions with a strong social science faculty.

› Cognitive Science

Combines psychology, linguistics and computer science — a strong fit if you are interested in AI and human-computer interaction.

› Sociology

Broader social science foundation, useful for policy, research and consulting work.

› Liberal Arts (Psychology major)

Flexible degree that allows you to combine psychology with economics, philosophy or design.

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Internships to target in the next 12 months

Psychology department research assistant

Email professors at local colleges or IITs directly, offering to assist with data collection or literature review. Most are open to motivated high school students.

NGO with a mental health or counselling focus

iCall, Vandrevalla Foundation and Snehi all have volunteer programmes. Check their websites for application details.

Behavioural research project

Design a small experiment — a survey, an observation study — on a question you find interesting. Submit it to school science fairs or post it on Medium.

Counsellor shadow

Ask your school counsellor if you can observe a few sessions (with consent). If not, ask to interview them about their work — most are glad to talk.

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Watch the first episode of "The Mind, Explained" on Netflix and write down two questions it raises for you. Then look up the syllabus for Psychology at one university you are curious about — see what they study in Year 1. If your school offers Psychology as a subject next year, find out whether you can add it.

● Have questions about this career section?

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CAREER 3 OF 3 — WRITING STORIES THAT CHANGE HOW PEOPLE THINK

Writing stories that change how people think

Why this fits you

You listed storytelling as something you do in your free time, and the quality you most admire is the ability to explain complex ideas simply. Those two things together describe exactly what journalism, documentary work and content strategy require. This is the domain that might surprise you — because it does not feel like a career path the way engineering or medicine does. But the demand for people who can make complicated things clear is genuine and growing.

Paths within this domain

› Journalist

Reports and writes stories for newspapers, magazines, digital platforms or broadcast, often specialising in a beat like technology, business or politics.

› Documentary filmmaker

Researches, scripts and produces long-form films that explore real events, people or ideas in depth.

› Content strategist

Plans what content a brand or publication should create, for whom, and how it should be structured to achieve a specific goal.

› Scriptwriter

Writes scripts for films, web series, podcasts or corporate videos, shaping how stories are told in audio and visual formats.

› Brand narrator

Develops the voice, tone and story of a company — covering everything from taglines to long-form brand journalism.

Stream and subject guidance

Humanities is the natural fit, but it is not required. Strong writers come from every stream. English as a subject matters much more than stream choice here. If your school offers Media Studies or Mass Communication as an elective, it is worth taking alongside whatever stream you choose. What you produce outside school — a blog, a newsletter, a short film — will matter more to admissions committees in this field than your board marks.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Journalism and Mass Communication (B.A.)

Direct entry into newsrooms, production houses and digital media companies.

› English Literature

Builds the reading and analytical depth that separates good writers from precise ones.

› Liberal Arts (Communication major)

Combines storytelling with social science, useful for policy communication and long-form journalism.

› Film and Television Production

Practical degree for documentary, web series and short-form content paths.

› Economics or Political Science

Counterintuitive but strong — specialist journalists with subject expertise are in high demand.

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Internships to target in the next 12 months

School or college newspaper	Start writing for your school publication now, or launch one if it does not exist. Published work, even at school level, is what journalism programmes look for.
Digital news outlet (student contributor)	Youth Ki Awaaz, The Quint and The News Minute accept pitches from student writers. Send a pitch with a story idea, not a general application.
Short documentary project	Shoot and edit a 3–5 minute documentary about something in your neighbourhood using a phone. Submit to student film festivals — MIFF and Kashish list student categories.
Content writing internship	Internshala has hundreds of content and copywriting internships. Choose companies whose products you find interesting — it makes the writing better and the reference stronger.

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Read one long article on The Ken (one free article per month, no paywall) and notice specifically how the writer opens and closes the piece. Then write 300 words about something you find genuinely interesting — not for anyone to read, just to see what you reach for when you have no brief. Save it. Read it in a week.

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PARENT SUMMARY

For parents to read

This page is written for you.

The rest of the report is written for your child. This page is for you.

Your child thinks by connecting ideas across different areas — psychology, technology, economics — rather than going deep into one subject early. That is not a lack of direction. It is a thinking style that tends to show up well in roles that sit between disciplines, which is where a lot of the most interesting work happens.

The assessment identified three domains worth exploring: building digital products, understanding how people make decisions, and communicating complex ideas as stories. These are not random — they connect directly to what your child described losing track of time doing, and to the qualities they most admire in people.

For stream choice, Science with Maths keeps the widest range of options open, including product, tech and psychology. The most useful conversation to have together is not "what career do you want?" but "which of these three directions feels closest to what you already do for fun?" That answer is usually more reliable.

The counsellor call

A CareerMap counsellor will call within 48 hours to walk you through this report. They have read it in full. Bring your questions, your doubts, and anything that did not feel right.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Three things to do now

1**Read the career that pulled you most**

Not the most impressive one. The one where you felt something while reading it. Go back to that chapter and read the 30-day step at the end.

2**Do the 30-day step for that career**

It is one specific action. It takes less than an hour to start. Do not wait until you feel ready.

3**Take the counsellor call**

A counsellor will contact you within 48 hours. The call is about this report and your next steps. Bring one question.

CareerMap 2025 · Confidential, for the student named on the cover only. Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Specific college options, entrance exams and cutoffs will be covered on your counsellor call.